

Muncie Redevelopment Commission November 20, 2025

Meeting Metadata	Details
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Muncie Redevelopment Commission: Meeting Summary Report

Meeting Date: November 20, 2025

Body: Muncie Redevelopment Commission (MRC)

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The meeting of the Muncie Redevelopment Commission was called to order on November 20, 2025, by the presiding officer.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Mr. Bishop, Mr. Dale, Mr. Miller, Miss Waggley, and Mr. Low (in the audience).
 - **Members Absent:** Mr. Pbilla.
 - **Presiding Officer:** Not explicitly stated by name in the opening roll call, but led by the chair/officer conducting proceedings.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** Roll call was conducted immediately upon calling the meeting to order.
 - **Approval of Minutes:**
 - The agenda for the November 20, 2025 meeting was approved as submitted by voice vote following a motion and second.
 - Prior meeting memoranda/minutes were discussed with corrections offered regarding speaker attributions (attributing specific statements to Mr. Dale rather than general recording phrasing) and the reporting of facade grant funding rollover questions. The minutes were approved with these amendments by voice vote.
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:02:35 Claims Approval**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Wright.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Mr. Wright presented the claims sent out the prior afternoon, highlighting expenditures for park improvements at Gateway Park (out front) and Riverview Park.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by voice vote following a motion and second.
- **00:02:37 City Administration Updates**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Hal (Jeff).
 - **Deliberation Summary:**
 - **Ready 2.0 Funding & Housing:** The city was awarded \$6.75 million in Ready 2.0 funding, which combines with over \$10 million in city infrastructure investments. This supports the Muny Central City Housing Project (34 new homes in the Old West End, plus additional developer homes) and a 4-story multi-use/multi-unit building at the point (approx. 100 homes and retail space; anchor tenant discussions are shifting toward alternative developer visions).
 - **Muny Mall:** Environmental cleanup and interior demo are underway near McGarry. The city is pursuing alternative funding opportunities after missing initial Ready 2.0/Lily allocations for the mall.
 - **Coulson Property Lease:** A lease was executed with the Coulson property. If testing provisions are met, the project will yield a \$96,000 upfront payment, \$500/month, and approximately \$280,000 value for otherwise underutilized land.
 - **New Subdivisions:** D.R. Horton submitted a plan for a 126-home subdivision off Morrison (north of Petty), featuring ranch and two-story homes priced between \$300k<U+2013>\$350k. Planning is also underway for a 200-to-

250-home development at the sports plex, phased to include starter and scaled homes.

- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational report; no formal board action required.
- **00:15:04 Facade Grant Status Update & Approvals**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Bishop.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The committee received 10<U+2013>12 total facade grant applications and recommended approval for five projects today, tabling the remaining for additional quotes and clarity.
 1. *Jonathan Chamblas (Crew Construction - 215 S. Walnut)*: New office space and storefront split entrances. Total cost \$143,000; grant capped at \$25,000 (Historic Preservation Commission certificate approved).
 2. *Michael Jennings (307 E. North)*: Residential remodel in the Gilbert National Historic District. Requesting \$8,600 (total project cost ~\$67,000).
 3. *Cindy Buchanan / Four Tabs LLC (306 S. Walnut - Columbia Building / Mark III tap room / Ball State lease space)*: Facade and parapet/tile restoration. Total cost over \$200k; capped at \$25,000.
 4. *William Peekpaw (400 W. Jackson)*: Sidewalk replacement in front of offices. Total cost \$2,277; grant request of 50% (\$1,013.50).
 5. *Minitrista Museum and Gardens (620 W. Minitrista Blvd - LL Ball House / Bob Ross Museum)*: General brick repair, mortar cleaning, and restoration. Total cost \$33,250; grant request capped at \$15,000.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:**
 - **00:49:48** Tanya (Executive Director, Muny Arts and Culture Council) spoke regarding 306 S. Walnut, noting it hosts the “On the Mark” mural commemorating the Pulse nightclub shooting. She questioned whether the proposal impacts the mural and emphasized community and advocacy group interest in preserving public art.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:**
 - The initial motion to approve all five facade grants passed unanimously by voice/roll call vote.
 - **00:55:43** A subsequent motion was made and seconded to amend the approval for 306 South Walnut (Cindy Buchanan project) to add a contingency stipulating that no alterations or damage be made to the existing mural. **Passed Unanimously by Roll Call Vote.**
- **00:29:17 Land Bank & Tax Sale Update**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Nate Howard and Zach (Muny Land Bank).
 - **Deliberation Summary:**
 - The Land Bank sold three properties last month (all houses) for \$10k each to developers, including a 4-unit property in the Old West End slated for rental preservation.

- An urban planning third-year studio from Ball State will present a corridor redevelopment plan for the Industry neighborhood on December 5th (12:30-2:00 p.m. at the Mad Jacks building).
- Zach presented findings on the 2025 tax sale (available at mylandbank.org/tax-sales/summary-2025). Out of 522 parcels listed in Muny, 191 sold (recouping \$376k in delinquent taxes/fines), while 331 went unsold, leaving \$2.8 million in tax delinquency on the table. The data indicates the sale is heavily driven by a small group of repeat speculative buyers generating high interest on redemptions rather than local redevelopment.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational report; no formal board action required.

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **00:46:09 Charles Jameson (Muny resident):**
 - Expressed excitement regarding the finalization of the Ready grant.
 - Addressed the planned 34 homes in the Old West End, expressing hope that architectural designs and renderings will carefully blend in and harmonize with the existing neighborhood character rather than standing out negatively.
- **00:48:47 Tanya (Executive Director, Muny Arts and Culture Council):**
 - Provided comments and questions regarding 306 South Walnut Street (the Columbia building facade application), highlighting the historic and cultural significance of the building's south-facing mural commemorating the Pulse nightclub shooting, and advocating for its protection. *(Note: Addressed substantively under Section 4).*

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - **Canton Commons Holiday Events:** Miss Waggley updated the commission on Canton Commons holiday preparations, including lighting repairs, tree maintenance, and the upcoming "Light Up" parade and First Thursday event scheduled for December 4th (parade starting at 5:30 p.m. from City Hall to Canton Commons; festival running 5:00 p.m. to 8:00 p.m.). Activities include a makers market, mechanical Rudolph, ice skating, food trucks, and stage performances by the Maybel carolers, Muny Community Schools elementary choir, and Muny Central color guard.
 - **Future Agenda Items:** Upcoming discussions include evaluating facade grant application form updates, program roll-over fund policies, second appraisals for jury lots, and downtown ADA sidewalk pad completions.

- **Adjournment:** Official adjournment to the next regular meeting scheduled for **December 18, 2025**.
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